Listing 4.2. Two identical conditional statements

```
if(this == that) {
doSomething(this);
else {
doSomethingElse(that);
}

(this == that) ? doSomething(this) : doSomethingElse(that);
```

Statement 1 = 5 LOC

Statement 2 = 1 LOC

In this simple case two statements do the same thing, yet their LOC is very different. Both perform the same and produce the same result. The reason to choose one over the other is personal preference, so which is better? Examples like this show that LOC is a metric that can't tell you if changing code is good or bad without taking into account the trends over time.

There are a number of standard charts for SCM data for trending change. If you look at any GitHub project, you'll find standard charts that you can get to through the Pulse and Graph sections. FishEye produces the same charts for SVN-based projects. As an example in anticipation of our next chapter, we'll look at the GoCD repo in GitHub, which is the source for a CI and pipeline management server.

Figure 4.10 shows the GitHub Pulse tab, which gives you an overview of the current state of the project. The most valuable section here is the pull request overview on the left side of the page.

Figure 4.10. The Pulse page on GitHub gives you info on pull requests, issues, and amount of change. This is from the GoCD repo (github.com/gocd/gocd/pulse/weekly).